



No back pay after furlough, emails hint

Despite law, notices cite payment only for those on job during shutdown

BY HANNAH NATANSON, JACOB BOGAGE AND RILEY BEGGIN

The Trump administration is sending notifications to federal staff suggesting that only those who are working during the government shutdown will be paid when it ends, despite a 2019 law that also guarantees pay to furloughed employees.

“Once an appropriation or continuing resolution is enacted, excepted employees are entitled to receive payment,” read one message sent to some portions of the government and obtained by The Washington Post. That sentence — which leaves out furloughed workers — was not included in the first furlough notice issued last month, according to an employee who, like others interviewed, spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution.

The government has been shuttered since Oct. 1, with Democrats and Republicans locked in a stalemate over health care policy. This past weekend, as the shutdown crossed the 30-day mark, officials began sending formal messages to workers updating them on their employment status for the next 30 days, as is required by law.

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said Tuesday that the administration would negotiate over back pay as part of

SEE PAY ON A5

Gleaning minerals from spent batteries

Nevada plant offers hope of recycling costly metals rather than mining more

BY NICOLÁS RIVERO

SPARKS, NEV. — When an EV battery dies somewhere in North America, there’s a good chance it’ll wind up here, among the sand and shrubs of the desert, to be reborn.

This is the home of the biggest lithium-ion battery recycling plant in the United States. It’s where run-down batteries from every rechargeable device you can imagine are stacked, sorted and stored in neat rows in a 32-acre graveyard beneath the pale blue sky.

Redwood Materials, the company that runs this plant, will eventually break them down into their components and extract valuable metals such as lithium, nickel and cobalt, which can be remade into new batteries.

As global demand for rechargeable batteries grows, recycling plants like this one can become an important source of raw materials — potentially displacing mines known for dire worker conditions, polluting the water and air and creating geopolitical tensions.

SEE BATTERIES ON A15

Spanberger leads sweep by Democrats



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Virginia Gov.-elect Abigail Spanberger, accompanied by her family, takes the stage Tuesday at Democrats’ watch party in Richmond.

Jones rides blue wave, overcomes texting scandal

BY TEO ARMUS

Former Democratic state delegate Jay Jones was projected to become Virginia’s next attorney general, according to the Associated Press, riding a wave of enthusiasm for his party to overcome a scandal over violent text messages he sent years ago that nearly toppled his campaign.

His victory over incumbent Attorney General Jason Miyares (R) makes Jones, the 36-year-old scion of a prominent Norfolk family of civil rights leaders, the first African American to be elected to an office he hopes to

use as a bulwark against the Trump administration.

The leaked text messages from 2022 — in which he nonchalantly mused about shooting the former GOP speaker of the House of Delegates in the head — cast a national spotlight on Jones as Election Day approached and made him a foil for Republicans in and outside Virginia.

Even after Jones repeatedly apologized for the texts, Miyares seized on the messages that Jones sent to a Republican state delegate to argue that he was unfit for statewide office. Some polls in subsequent weeks showed the

two virtually tied.

But the drumbeat of attacks from Miyares were no match for the heavy Democratic turnout that also propelled former congresswoman Abigail Spanberger into the governor’s seat and put the party on track to hold full control of state government and widen its majority in the House of Delegates.

“I want to thank every Virginian tonight who placed their trust in me,” Jones told a crowd of jubilant Democrats in downtown Richmond, avoiding a direct mention of the scandal. “The weight of that trust is not lost on

me at all. Nor is the history that led us to this moment right here.”

Virginia’s statewide elections are often seen as a test of voter sentiment in the year after a presidential contest. The state has historically favored gubernatorial candidates from the party that is not in the White House, though sometimes splitting votes in downballot races.

SEE JONES ON A12

Trump lobs insults: He says Jews backing Mamdani are “stupid.” A13

Key takeaways: Democrats romp, Mamdani wins, Trump rebuked. A13

DICK CHENEY 1941-2025

Pugnacious architect of the war on terrorism

BY BARTON GELLMAN AND MARC FISHER

Former vice president Dick Cheney, who recast an understudy’s job into an engine of White House power, becoming chief architect of a post-9/11 war on terrorism that involved bypassing restrictions against torture and domestic espionage, died Nov. 3. He was 84.

The cause was complications from pneumonia and cardiac and vascular disease, according to a statement from his family. They did not say where he died.

Heart disease had shadowed Mr. Cheney most of his adult life and was a particular concern during his two terms as next-in-line to President George W. Bush. He suffered the first of five heart attacks at 37 and had eight “cardiac events” between the 2000 and 2008 elections.

After the catastrophic attacks of Sept. 11, 2001, on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon, Mr. Cheney, the nation’s 46th vice president, took on the role of primary strategist in all-out military deployments

in Afghanistan and, later, Iraq. As part of this multi-trillion-dollar campaign, intelligence officers were dispatched to use “any means at our disposal,” as Mr. Cheney put it, to find and kill terrorists and those who aided them.

Mr. Cheney and his senior lieutenants, Chief of Staff I. Lewis “Scooter” Libby and legal counsel David Addington, worked in strict secrecy to circumvent or reinterpret legal prohibitions against torture, domestic espionage and clandestine imprisonment without charge. Mr. Cheney said in 2008 that “it would have been unethical or immoral for us not to do everything we could in order to protect the nation.” A 9/11-style attack, he said, “wasn’t going to happen again on our watch.”

Before joining Bush’s ticket in 2000, Mr. Cheney amassed unsurpassed credentials, having served as White House chief

SEE CHENEY ON A8

The Take: Ultimate GOP insider saw party go another way. A11



DIANA WALKER/LIAISON/GETTY IMAGES

After 9/11, Vice President Dick Cheney — seen in 1989 — believed the power of the presidency needed to be reasserted.

White House nears deal to lower costs of obesity drugs

BY DAN DIAMOND AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

The White House is expected to announce a deal this week with Eli Lilly and Novo Nordisk that would lower the price of their popular obesity drugs to \$149 per month in some cases, according to four people familiar with the agreement who spoke on the condition of anonymity to preview the deal.

The drugs would also be covered for some Medicare beneficiaries, potentially expanding access to the medication for millions of Americans, the people said. Medicare can cover Novo Nordisk’s Ozempic and Wegovy to treat diabetes and Eli Lilly’s Zepbound for sleep apnea, but the coverage does not extend to weight loss.

An announcement could come as soon as Thursday, with President Donald Trump expected to personally tout the deal as part of his ongoing efforts to lower drug prices, one of the people said. The deal is seen as one of the most significant in the administration’s

SEE MEDICARE ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Fast-melting glacier An ice sheet in Antarctica vanished at a record pace, a possible omen for eventual sea-level rise. A7

Trial over hurled hoagie Lawyers for a man who threw a sandwich at a federal agent in a show of protest in Washington called the case against him a “blatant abuse of power.” B13

THE NATION
A Post-ABC-Ipsos poll finds growing discontent among Americans as inflation worsens. A3
A group backed by conservative donors is bankrolling opposition to the president’s tariffs. A4

THE WORLD
American tariffs on pasta from Italy could soon soar to nearly 107 percent as a result of a Commerce Department investigation of alleged “dumping” by exporters. A6

THE ECONOMY
A rally in tech stocks faltered as a prominent short-seller targeted two AI giants, drawing the ire of Palantir’s CEO. A14
As the shutdown drags on, be sure to balance kindness and caution when helping those in need, Michelle Singletary writes. A14

STYLE
Zoe Deutch reintroduces viewers to actress Jean Seberg in a film on the making of a French New Wave classic. B1

SPORTS
Alex Ovechkin is struggling for the Capitals, having scored just twice in 12 games. But he’s not overly concerned. B7

THE REGION
Maryland Gov. Wes Moore began the redistricting process despite opposition from the state Senate president. B13

FOOD
Learn how to bake with nut flours, a flavorful and nutrient-rich staple when making gluten-free treats. E1

BUSINESS NEWS.....A14
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B16
OPINION PAGES.....A16
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A6

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54391

